Pranav Thakur

Growth & Performance Creative Strategist

Creative strategy · Paid acquisition (Meta) · AI video & static production · Art direction

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SUMMARY

Growth creative strategist who owns the full loop: customer research, angles, scripts, AI-produced video and statics, Meta account structure, testing and scaling. Sole owner of creative and media buying at a Y Combinator–backed SaaS (~$22K/month budget), where moving optimization down-funnel cut cost per trial by 54%. Previously directed creative for 30+ DTC and app brands at an Entrepreneurs First–backed AI studio, including a $750K/month Meta account.

EXPERIENCE

PumpGTM (Y Combinator) · Creative Strategist & Performance Marketer — Sep 2026 – Present

- Sole owner of paid acquisition and creative; run ~$22K/month across US winners, testing and retargeting campaigns ($14.4K+ deployed since September).
- Moved Meta optimization from lead events to InitiatedCheckout/StartTrial, cutting US cost per trial from $368 to $168 (−54%) and driving 41 card-upfront trials.
- Concepted and scripted the company's highest-converting hook (“Turn Claude into your sales assistant”): 6.22% CTR and 60%+ of all paid retargeting trials.
- Built a modular 16-ad-set testing structure ($30/day per concept, $20/day caps on unproven ideas): 96 ads tested in 30 days at a ~13% win rate, with winners graduated to CBO scaling (top ad $20 → $111/day).
- Set first-frame text-hook standards for all video ads; resolved retargeting audience-exclusion conflicts.

GrowthPod · AI Visual Artist — 2026 – Present

- Produce art-directed AI visuals for brand campaigns at a creative studio.

Novelty Studios (Entrepreneurs First) · Performance Creative Strategist & AI Producer — Jan 2026 – Sep 2026

- Grew from AI filmmaker to creative strategist: picked angles, wrote and revised scripts, and decided what got produced for 30+ DTC and app brands (~40 creatives/month).
- Penrose Skin ($750K/month on Meta): directed concepts and format variations as ROAS rose from 1.1 to 1.5.
- VYVE: built persona-pain-first creative (40 concepts × 3 hooks × 2 bodies) as ROAS went from 0.7 to 2+ for four consecutive weeks.
- Aesthetic Match: AI UGC app walkthroughs as cost per qualified lead fell from $49 to $31.
- Delivered a 30-second AI launch film for Mem0 in three days, from concept and script to final edit.

Nago Media · Video Editor & Content Producer — Aug 2025 – Jan 2026

- Edited retention-focused YouTube content for creators including FUT Crunch and Gorilla (audiences in the millions); shaped hooks and sequencing.

Freelance · Video Editor & Creative Producer — 2023 – Jul 2025

- Produced long- and short-form video for clients, from brief to final delivery, while completing a CS degree.

SKILLS

Growth & performance	Meta Ads (event optimization, CBO/ABO, retargeting), creative-testing frameworks, funnel and CAC analysis, ROAS / CPA / CTR
Creative strategy	Customer and competitor research, positioning, angles, hooks, scripts, briefs
AI production	Seedance, Kling, Higgsfield, ElevenLabs, Suno
Craft	Art direction, Premiere Pro, After Effects, motion, colour, sound design

EDUCATION

B.Tech, Computer Science & Engineering · Jaypee University of Information Technology, Solan — 2025